



Figure 6: The photo gallery



Figure 7: The personal settings page

Apps tab under the *Settings* menu. There are not too many applications as of now, but let's hope for a better future!

Here are some more features and tweaks that you may find useful.

Increasing the maximum upload file size

An irritation with the ownCloud Web interface is that, by default, it does not allow for files greater than 2 MB to be uploaded to the server. To increase this limit, we have to edit the `php.ini` file (usually located at `/etc/php5/apache2/php.ini`) and change the value of `upload_max_filesize` and `post_max_size` parameters to the value we want. After saving the file, restart Apache to see your changes take effect!

Syncing files with webDAV

OwnCloud allows for file synchronisation with the help of the webDAV protocol. This is an open standard that works with almost any platform, including Linux, Windows, Mac and even mobile platforms like Android, etc. To set up webDAV in Nautilus, go to *File > Connect to server*, and select webDAV as the connection type. Type in details like the server location, files, username, password, etc. and you're good to go. These details will usually be available from the personal section under the *Settings* menu in the Web interface. A major bug that I stumbled on was that webDAV reports incorrect information related to the free space left on the server, and that we are able to upload files, ignoring the warning. Alternatively, you can try setting up webDAV with the help of the `davfs` package, as described at owncloud.org/support/webdav/.

Music streaming with Ampache server

OwnCloud can stream music to any desktop player that supports the *ampache* protocol, like Amarok, Tomahawk, etc. We can use Banshee to stream music with the help of the *banshee-extension-ampache* package, which needs to be installed separately. Just enter



Figure 8: The text editor



Figure 9: Connecting via webDAV with Nautilus

the Ampache media link shown on the personal settings page, along with your ownCloud login details in your player's settings, and you'll be streaming music in no time.

The verdict

Using ownCloud is an altogether different experience, compared to other services like Dropbox. I must say no other service will ever provide such a wide array of features like music streaming, online editing, photo galleries, etc. It does seem like a very good choice if you want to get a taste of the cloud, and set up media streaming within your own local intranet, or on a Web server, without any storage restrictions. Overall, the software has a good feel to it, and is in active development, though the current release does have a few bugs here and there. Also, the documentation needs a lot of work, in order to attract new users. The next release is proposed to be out in the next two to three months. Some of the features you should be looking forward to are encryption, editing of complex document formats like .ODT and .DOC, a native desktop, smart-phone (Android and WebOS) synchronisation applications, and many more you haven't even thought of! 

Links

- [1] OwnCloud Download Link: www.gitorious.org/owncloud/owncloud/archive-tarball/master
- [2] OwnCloud documentation: owncloud.org/support/
- [3] OwnCloud commercial: www.owncloud.com

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The author has a crush on Java, and also loves flirting with almost everything related to databases, cloud computing and Web technologies. Feel free to comment on this article, and direct your feedback to ankitreloaded@gmail.com.